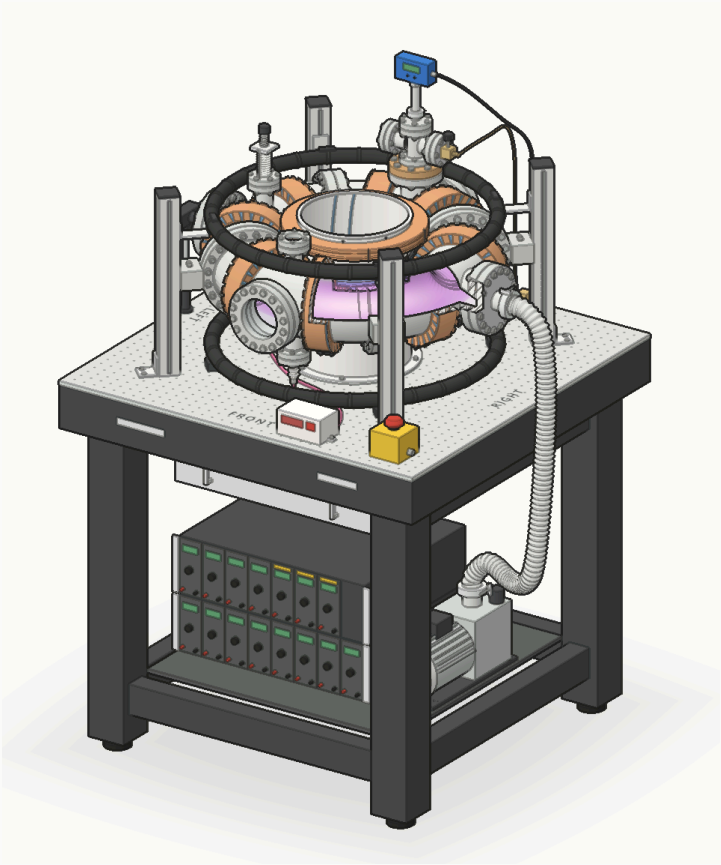
User guide

SPM1 anatomy

How to use the interactive 3D anatomy of the MinimaK SPM1, a tabletop magnetised torus by Rideo Systems



What it is

A 3D model you can turn, take apart and read. For each of the machine's 29 components it shows what the part is, how it attaches to the next one, what it is made of, and where each number comes from. It does not simulate the plasma physics.

Opening it

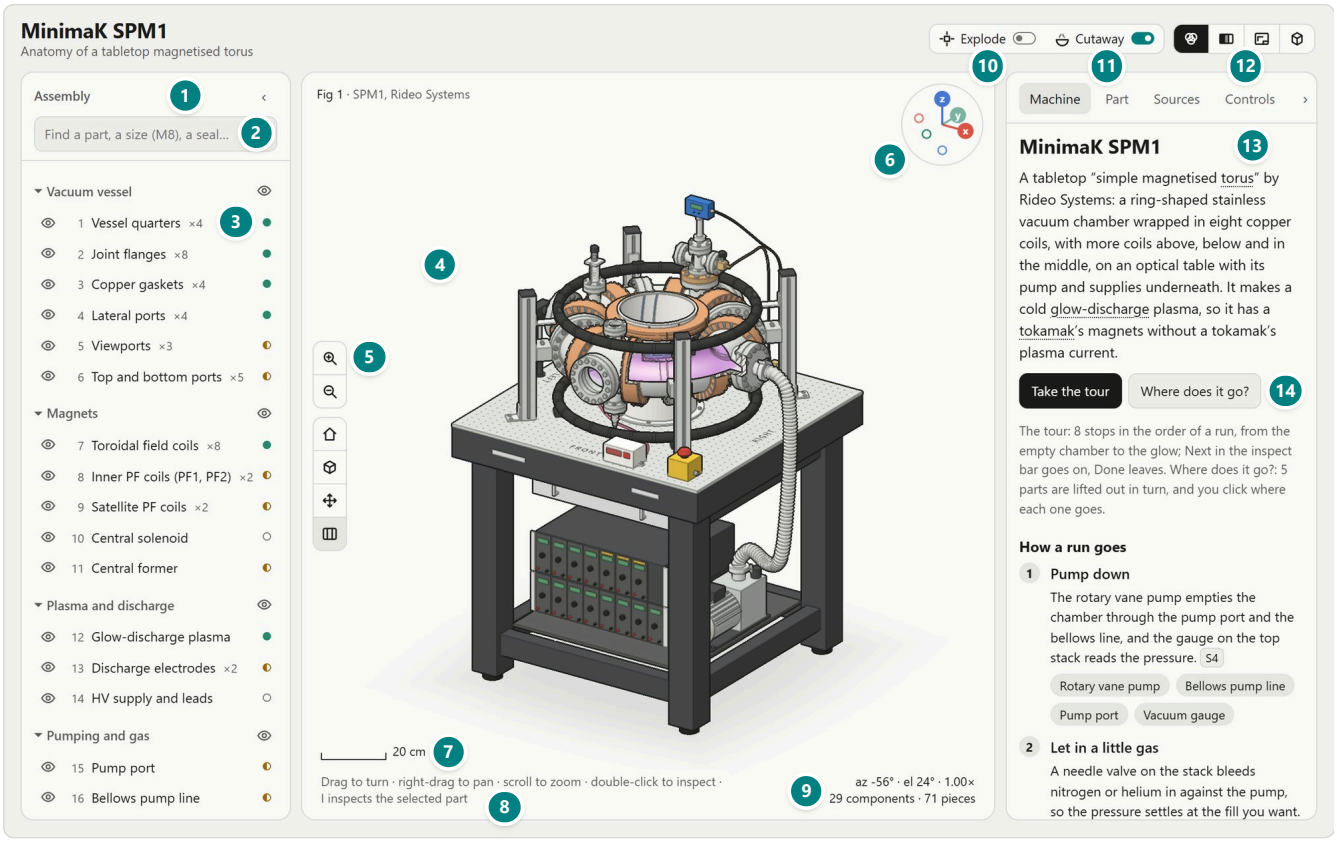
Open `index.html` in a recent browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari). There is nothing to install. The first time it opens, it needs an internet connection to load its 3D library.

In this guide

1 The page at a glance 2
2 Moving round the model 3
3 Finding a part 4
4 Inspecting a part 5
5 Taking a part apart 6
6 Sheets and Show me 7
7 Where the numbers come from 8
8 The whole machine: Explode and Cutaway 9
9 Learning the machine: the tour and the quiz 10
10 Four themes 11
11 Phones and tablets 12
12 Links, settings and access 13
13 Keys and gestures 14

1 The page at a glance

The page has three columns: the assembly list on the left, the 3D view in the middle and the inspector on the right. The bar at the top changes the whole machine.



1. **Assembly list.** All 29 components in seven groups. Click a name to select the part; double-click to inspect it. On a first visit the list is folded to a thin rail: click its magnifier, or press /.
2. **Search.** Find a part by name, size or seal: *M8*, *o-ring*, *viewport bolt*.
3. **Basis dot.** How far to trust the drawn shape: ● published spec, ◐ from photos, ○ assumed. The eye beside each row hides the part or group.
4. **The 3D view.** Drag to turn, right-drag to pan, scroll to zoom. Until you touch it, it turns slowly on its own.
5. **View buttons.** Zoom in and out, the home view, **Views** (look from a side), pan mode, and the side panels.
6. **Axis triad.** Shows which way is up; click an axis end to look along it.
7. **Scale bar.** True at every zoom: the view has no perspective, so sizes can be compared anywhere in it.
8. **Hint.** What a click or a drag does right now. It changes as you go.
9. **Readout.** The view's angles and zoom, and what is shown or selected.
10. **Explode.** Takes every component off the machine at once (page 9).
11. **Cutaway.** Cuts the top off the vessel to show the plasma inside.
12. **Theme.** Colour, Greyscale, Blueprint or Hologram (page 11).
13. **Inspector.** Four tabs: **Machine** (what it is, how a run goes), **Part** (the selected part), **Sources** and **Controls**.
14. **Take the tour** and **Where does it go?**, a guided tour and a quiz (page 10).

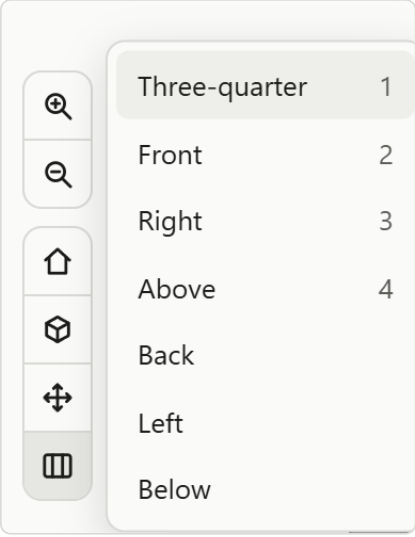
Make room. Drag the edge between a side panel and the view to size the panel; double-click the edge for the default width. The panels button at the view's left edge, or F, folds both side panels so the model gets the whole window.

2 Moving round the model

The model turns like a turntable: sideways spins it about its vertical axis, up and down tilts it. The vertical always stays up, so you never lose your bearings.

To	Mouse	Touch	Keys
Turn	Drag	One finger	Arrow keys
Pan	Right-drag, Shift-drag or middle-drag; or switch on the pan button, then drag	Two fingers	Shift + arrows
Zoom	Scroll wheel (it zooms toward the pointer), or the zoom buttons	Pinch	+ −
Home view	The home button, or double-click empty space	The home button	0
Fit everything shown	—	—	A
Look from a side	**Views** menu, or click an axis end on the triad	The same	1 three-quarter, 2 front, 3 right, 4 above
Fold the side panels	The panels button	The panels button	F

Keys work once the model has focus: click it first. While inspecting a part, the home view frames that part instead of the whole machine.



The view buttons and the **Views** menu. From the top: zoom in, zoom out, home, Views, pan mode, side panels. The menu works from the keyboard too: ↑ ↓ move, Enter picks, Esc closes.



The axis triad

The filled ends are the positive axes, with their letters (x red, y green, z blue, z up); the hollow rings are the negative ends. Click any end to look from that side.

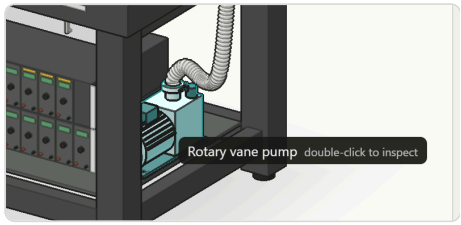
The table's sides

The table's edges are printed with the quarters above them: **Front**, **Right**, **Back** and **Left**. Parts are named by these sides, as in *Left viewport* or *Right–back joint*.

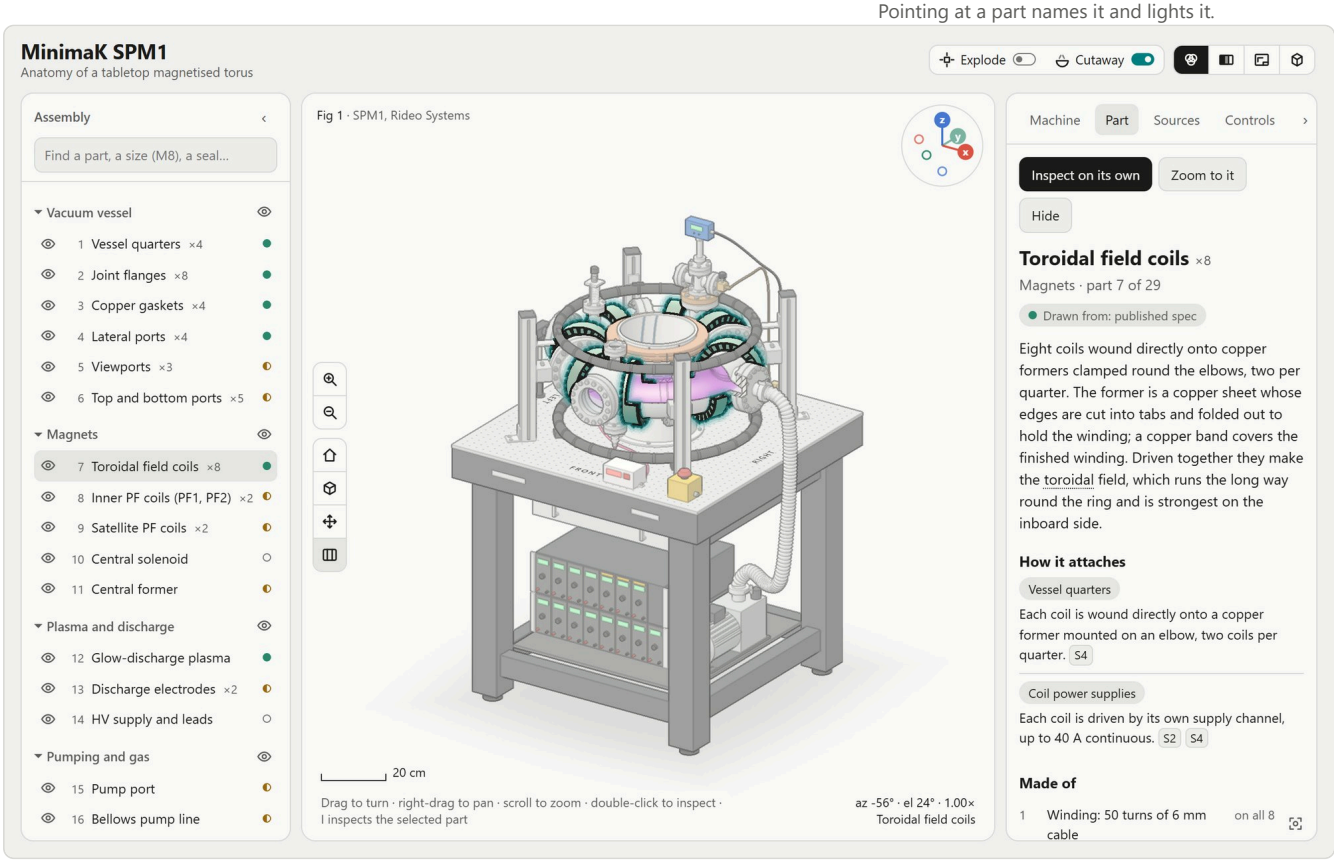
> **Lost?** Press 0 or double-click empty space to go back to the home view.

3 Finding a part

Point at any part to see its name; click it to select it. A selected part gets a teal layer and outline, the rest of the machine fades back, and the **Part** tab tells you about it.



Pointing at a part names it and lights it.



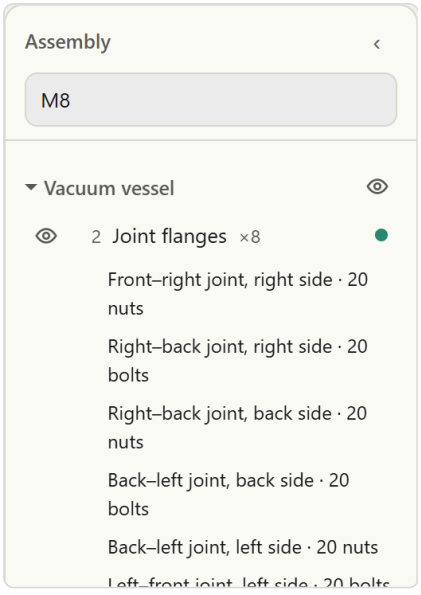
The toroidal field coils selected, from the model or from the list. The Part tab offers **Inspect on its own**, **Zoom to it** and **Hide**.

The assembly list

- **Click** a name to select the part; **double-click** to inspect it.
- **×4** after a name is how many pieces the part has.
- **The eye** hides a part, or a whole group, and shows it again.
- **The dot** is the part's basis: ● spec, ◐ photos, ○ assumed.

Search

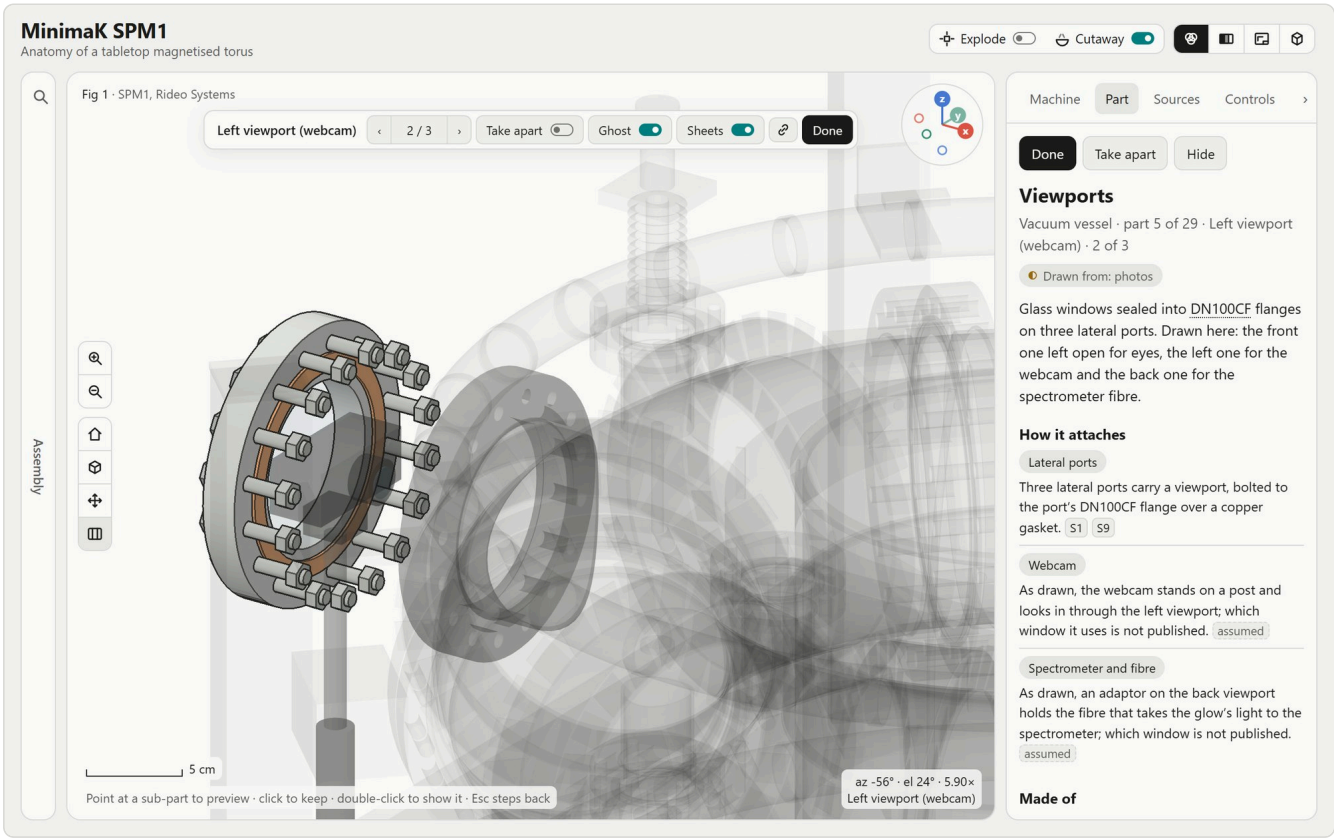
The box searches names, specs, descriptions and every sub-part's sheet. Try a size (*M8* lists every M8 bolt and nut), a seal (*o-ring*), or a question in plain words: *the gasket between the right and back quarters*. The best matches are listed, with matching pieces under their part; click one to inspect it. A line under the box says which words found nothing.



Searching for *M8*.

4 Inspecting a part

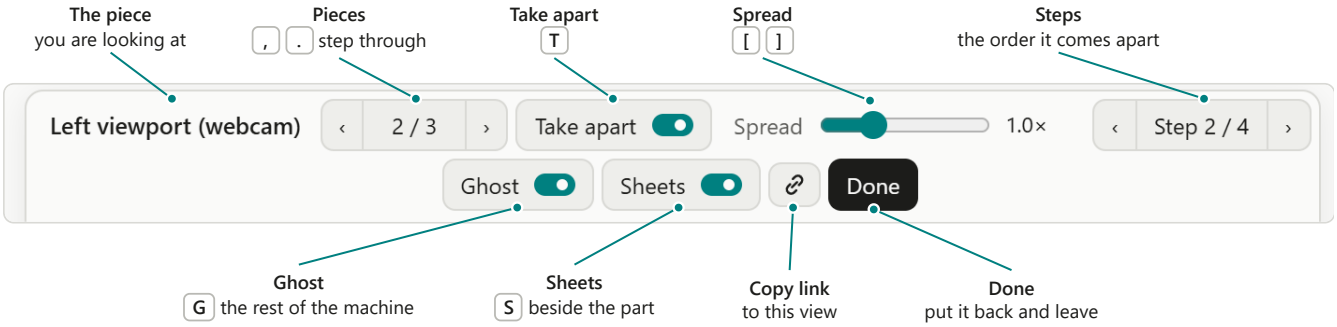
Inspecting shows one component on its own. The rest of the machine fades to an x-ray ghost, and the part lifts out while the camera glides round to frame it, so you can see where it comes from.



Inspecting the viewports, on the left one (piece 2 of 3). The parts it bolts to are drawn half solid with their bolts and nuts; the rest of the machine is a ghost.

To inspect a part: double-click it in the view or in the list, press **Inspect on its own** in the Part tab, or select it and press I.

The inspect bar



The Part tab

- **What it does**, and what it is made of.
- **How it attaches**: one sentence for each part it connects to. Click a name to inspect that part; ← **name** in the bar, or Backspace, goes back.
- **Made of**: its sub-parts, numbered. Each has a sheet (page 7).
- **Pieces**: where each piece of a repeated part sits, and what tells them apart.
- **Specification**: every row carries a source tag (page 8).

Getting back out

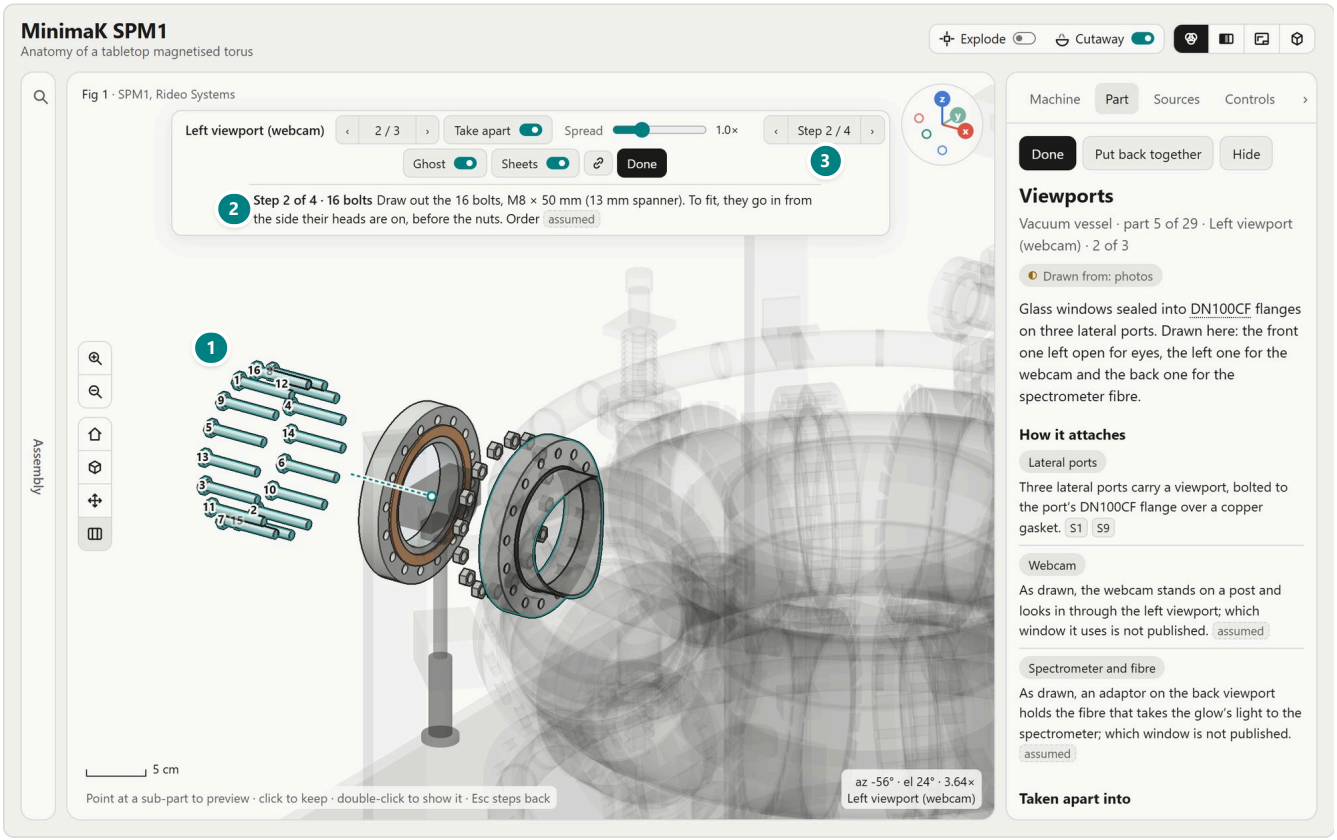
Esc steps back one level at a time: the preview, Show me, the opened joint, the step, the single piece, the part, then the selection. Kept sheets stay.

Done reverses the whole inspect at an explode's pace: the part goes back together, flies home while the camera returns to your earlier view, and the machine turns solid again.

A part with several pieces opens on all of them; click one to pick it, or use the arrows beside **All**.

5 Taking a part apart

Take apart (T) separates the inspected part into its sub-parts, each along the way it really comes off: bolts slide out, nuts come off the back, gaskets come out from between their flanges, a KF clamp opens. A weld never comes apart.



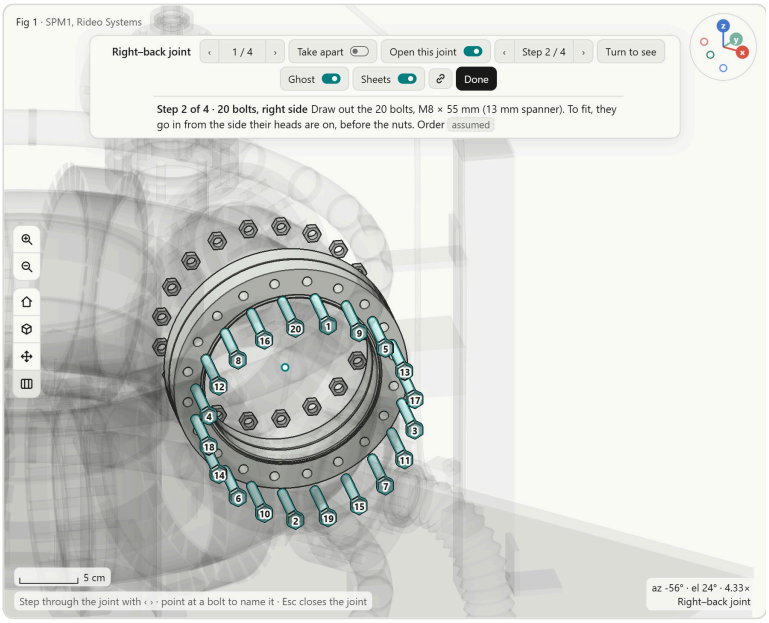
1. **Star order.** When a step takes off a ring of bolts or nuts, each head is numbered with its turn in the star (cross) tightening pattern: 1, 11, 6, 16 … round a 20-bolt flange. Point at one bolt to name it: *Bolt 7 of 20 · star 3*.
2. **How to do the step:** the size, length and spanner (*Draw out the 16 bolts, M8 × 50 mm, 13 mm spanner*), which way a knife edge faces, and that a copper gasket is never reused.
3. **Steps.** ‹ **Step 2 / 4** › walks through the order the sub-parts come off: nuts, then bolts, then the flange, a gasket last. **All** has every sub-part off; fitting runs back up the steps. No procedure is published, so the order is tagged assumed.

More

- **Spread** (slider, or [ ]) sets how far apart the sub-parts go.
- A **dotted trail** from a hollow ring shows where the sub-part under the pointer sat, and the way it came off.
- **Turn to see** appears when the sub-parts come apart toward you and hide each other. It turns the view so they lie side by side. The view never turns by itself.

Open this joint

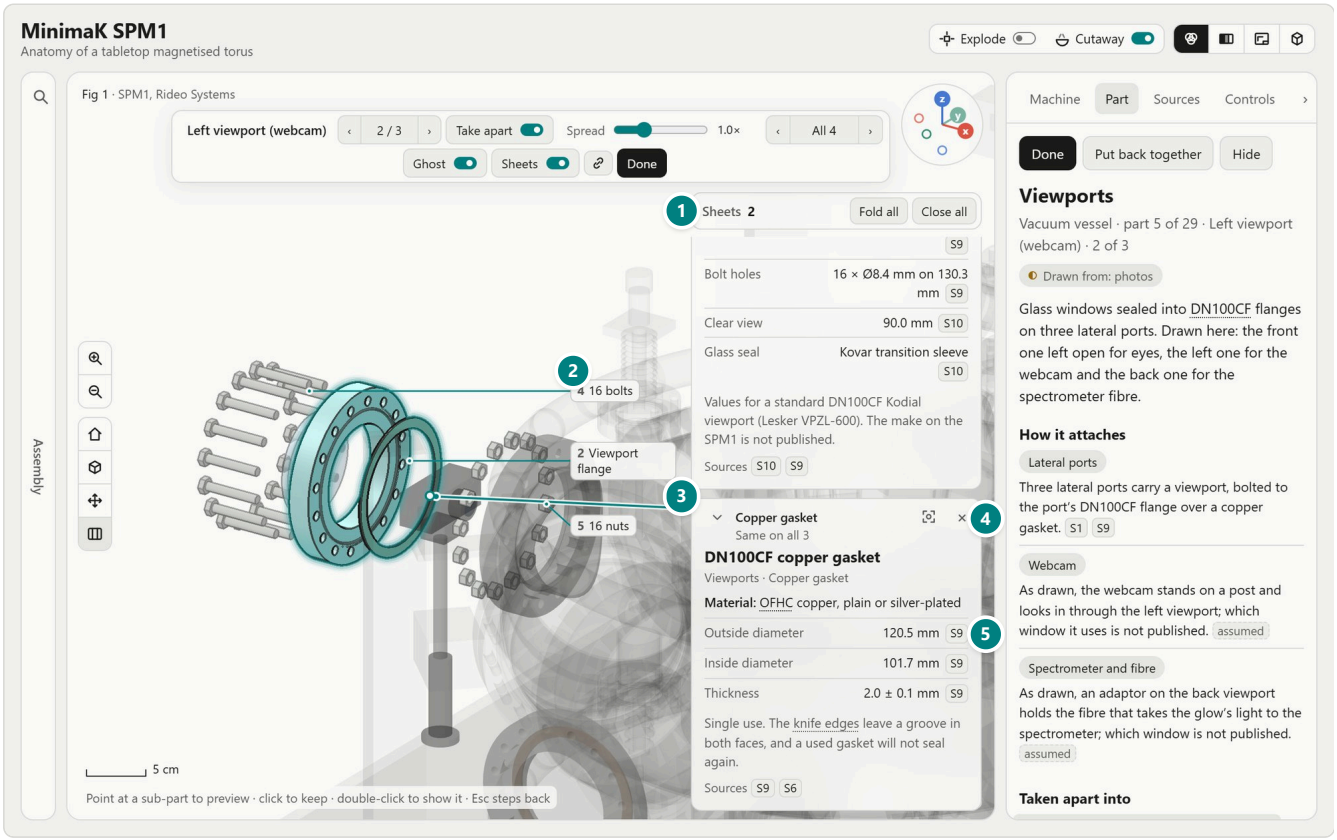
On a copper gasket or a joint flange, **Open this joint** (J) opens the whole vessel joint: the 20 nuts off in star order, the 20 bolts out, the two quarters eased apart, then the gasket out. Press it again, or Esc, to close it.



The right–back joint opened at step 2: its 20 bolts drawn out, each numbered with its turn in the star order.

6 Sheets and Show me

While you inspect, every sub-part has a technical sheet: its material, dimensions and notes, with a source on every row. Sheets sit in a column on the right of the view, where they never cover the part.



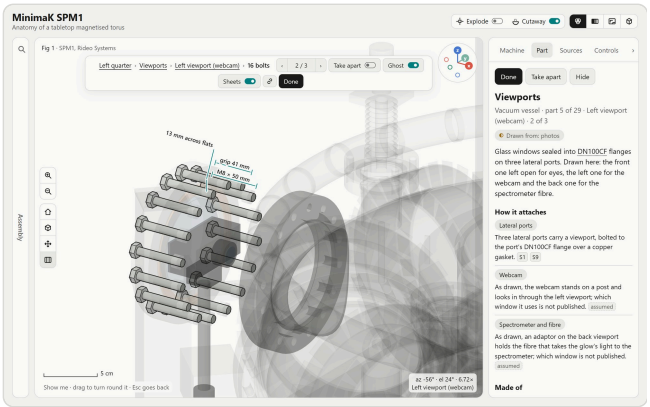
1. **The column** counts the kept sheets. **Fold all** folds them to their bars; **Close all** closes them.
2. **Callouts** name the sub-parts beside the part, numbered as the Made of rows. Click one to preview its sheet.
3. **The leader line** joins a sheet to its sub-part.
4. **A sheet's bar:** the chevron folds it, the frame button is Show me, × closes it. *Same on all 3*: a sheet belongs to the sub-part, so it is the same on every piece.
5. **Source tags** on every row say where the number comes from (page 8).

Preview and keep

- **Preview:** rest the pointer on a sub-part. Its sheet opens with a dashed edge, labelled *Preview*, and stays until you rest on another one.
- **Keep:** click the sub-part, press **Keep** on the preview, or click its row under **Made of**.
- **Float:** drag a sheet by its bar to anywhere on the view. **Tidy** (L) puts floating sheets back in the column.
- Each part remembers its sheets, folds and places for when you come back.

Show me

Brings one sub-part close up and dims the rest of the part. Use the frame button on a sheet's bar or a Made of row, Z, or double-click the sub-part. The bar shows where it is (*Left quarter › Viewports › Left viewport › 16 bolts*), and a ring of bolts gets its sizes drawn on. Esc goes back.



7 Where the numbers come from

Every number on the page carries a tag that says where it comes from, so you can tell a published figure from one read off a photo or picked for the drawing.

Tag	Meaning
S1 … S11	Published in that source. Click the tag to open it in the **Sources** tab; ← **back** returns you.
photo	Scaled from the photos in the 2025 webinar on the Minimak (S4).
measured	Measured on a top-down photo of an SPM1, with the camera fitted to parts of known size.
std	Follows from the ConFlat standard (S9); the SPM1's own part is not published.
derived	Worked out from tagged numbers: the vessel volume, the field on the axis.
assumed	Not published; picked for the drawing.

A key at the foot of each sheet and of the Part tab explains the tags it uses.

How far to trust a shape

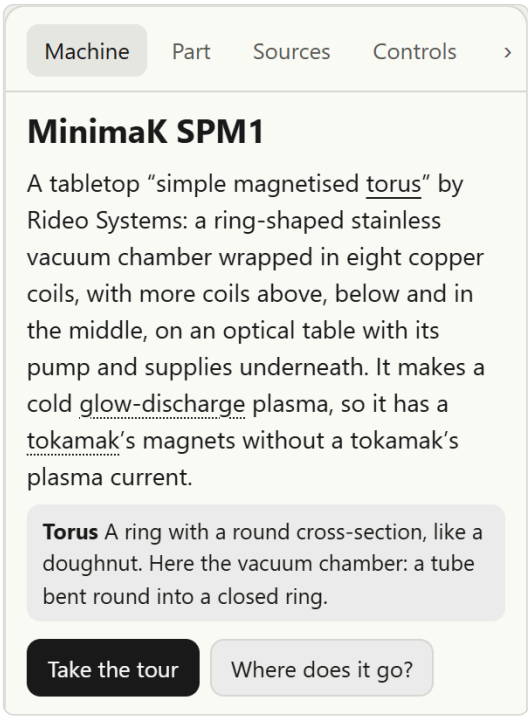
The Part tab says what the part's shape and position are drawn from, with the same dot as the list:

- ● **published spec**: the size or placement is published.
- ◐ **photos**: scaled or placed from photos.
- ○ **a guess**: placed where it is plausible.

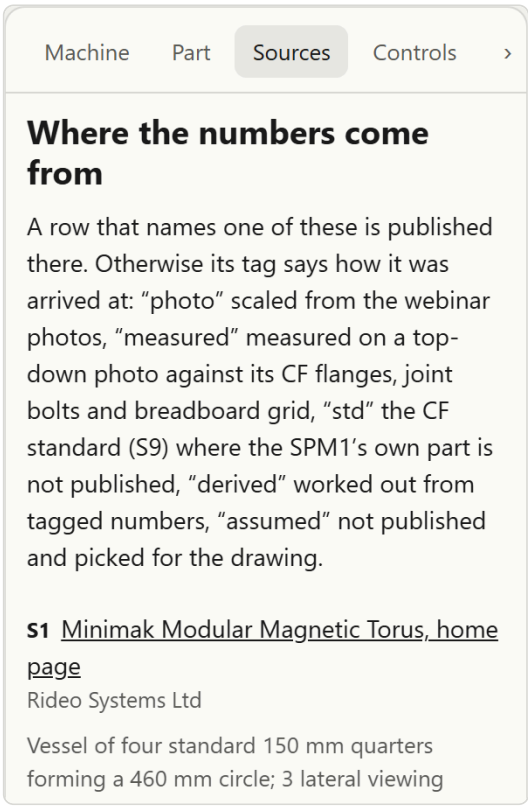
This is about the drawn shape, not the numbers in the rows, which have their own tags.

Words explained where they are used

About two dozen terms a first-year student may not know (torus, poloidal, ConFlat, knife edge, Pirani gauge, mbar and more) have a dotted underline the first time they appear. Click one, or Tab onto it, to open its definition under the paragraph; click again to close it.



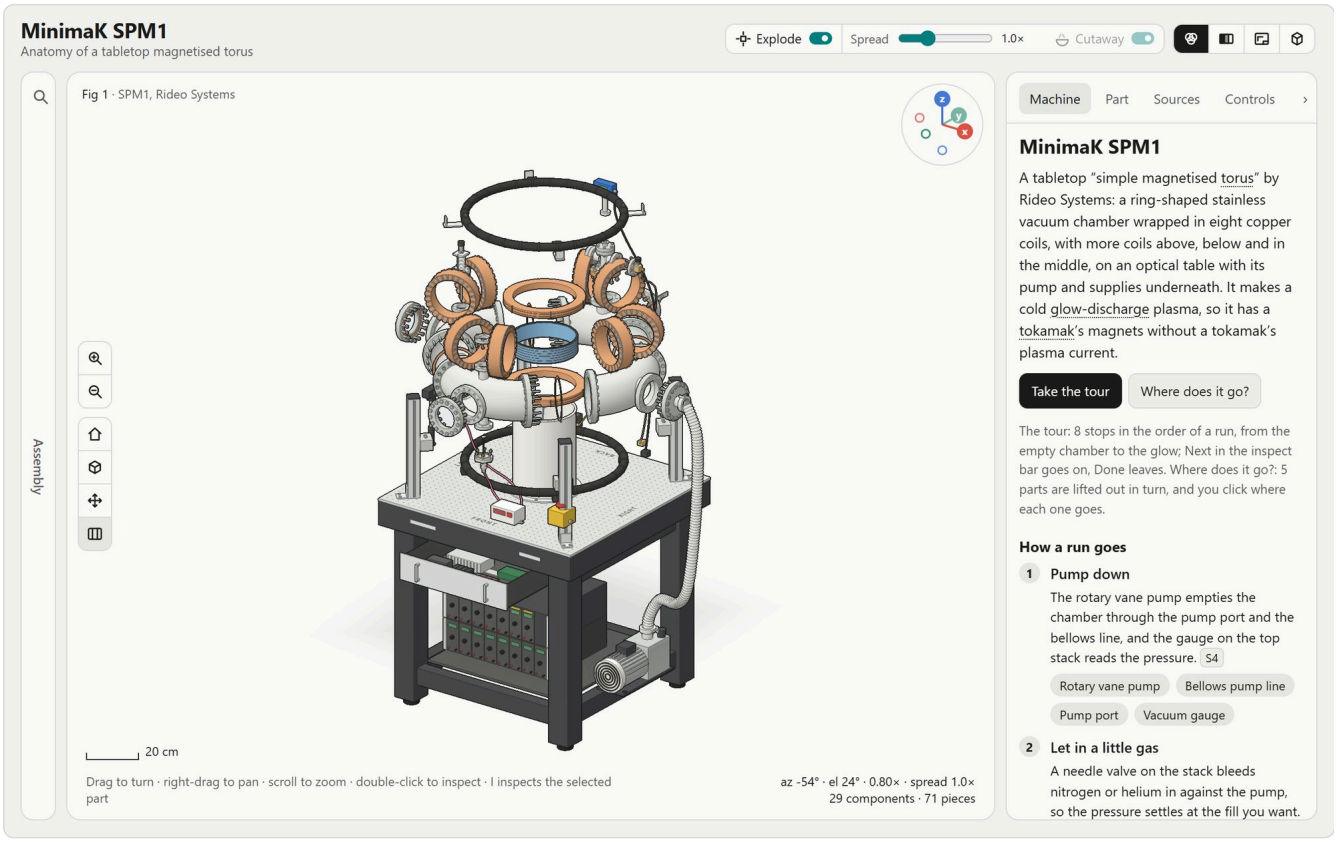
A click on *torus* opens its definition.



The Sources tab: every reference, what was taken from it, and how many rows cite it.

8 The whole machine: Explode and Cutaway

Explode (E) takes every component off the machine at once, so you can see how it all fits together.



Exploded and zoomed to fit (A). The quarters move out, the coils and ports lift off them, the PF and satellite coils rise, and the table, supplies and pump drop away. Cables and the pump hose stay plugged in at both ends.

Explode

- **Spread**, the slider beside the switch, or [ ], sets how far apart the parts go (0.4× to 2.5×).
- The plasma is off while the machine is apart. The windows are clear glass, so you can look into the vessel through any of them.

Cutaway and hiding

- **Cutaway** (C) cuts away the top of the vessel to show the glow inside. It is on when you open the page.
- **Hide** a part with its eye in the list, the **Hide** button in the Part tab, or H for the selected part. The eye on a group hides the whole group.
- **Fit** (A) zooms to whatever is shown, at the current angle.

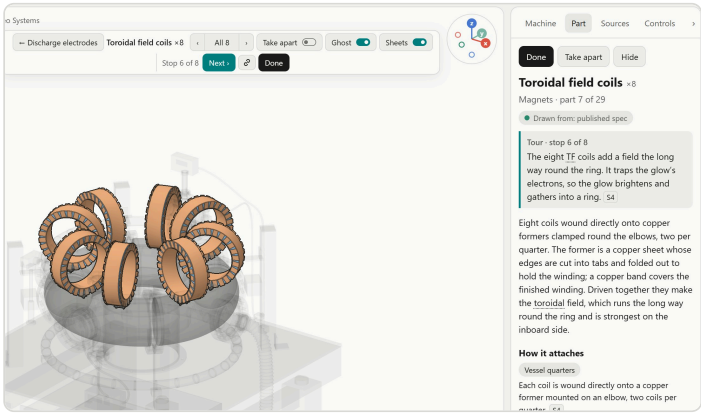
9 Learning the machine: the tour and the quiz

The **Machine** tab explains what the SPM1 is and how a run goes, in four steps: **pump down**, **let in a little gas**, **strike the glow** and **add the magnetic field**. Each step names the parts it uses; click a name to select that part. The order follows the 2025 webinar on the Minimak (S4); no operating procedure is published.

Take the tour

Inspects the parts in the order of a run, in eight stops from the empty chamber to the glow: the vessel, the pump, the gauge, the gas valve, the electrodes, the TF coils, PF1 and PF2, and the plasma.

- At each stop, a line in the Part tab says why that part matters at that point in the run.
- **Next** › in the inspect bar goes on; it shows *Stop 6 of 8*.
- You can look around at any stop: take the part apart, open sheets, follow links. Only **Done** leaves the tour.

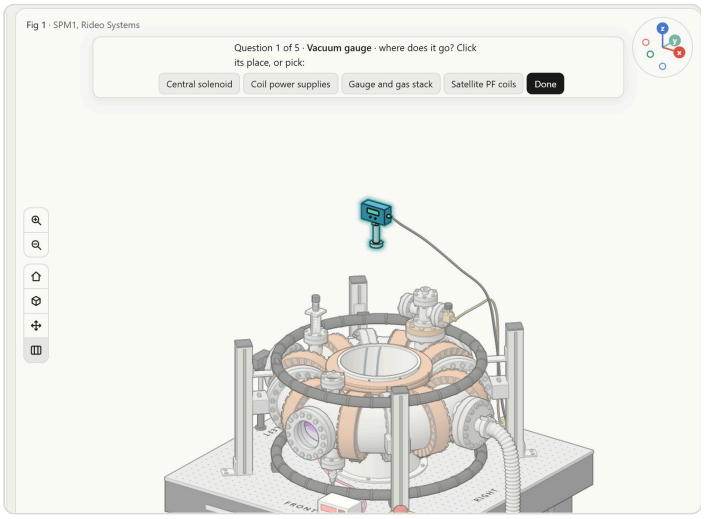


Stop 6 of 8: the toroidal field coils. The Part tab says why they matter now.

Where does it go?

A quiz of five questions. Each lifts a part out above the machine; click the place it belongs on the model, or pick one of four parts in the bar.

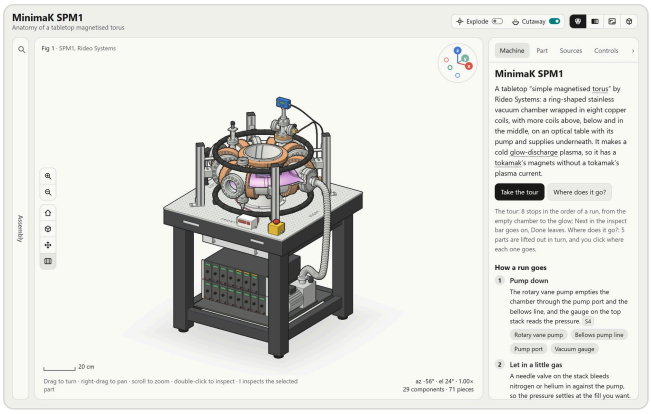
- A wrong answer names what you clicked and gives you one more try. Then the part flies home, its place is outlined, and the bar says how the two are joined.
- The round is scored on first tries; **New round** asks five more.
- A lecturer can send a round as a link (page 13).



The vacuum gauge is lifted out: click where it belongs, or pick in the bar.

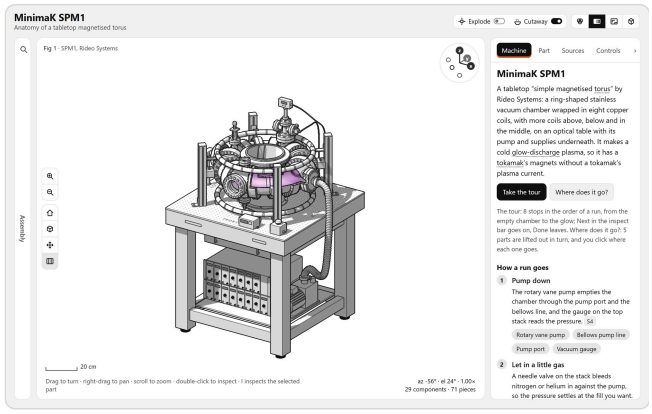
10 Four themes

The buttons at the right of the top bar switch between four ways of drawing the same machine. Everything works the same in every theme, and the page remembers your choice.



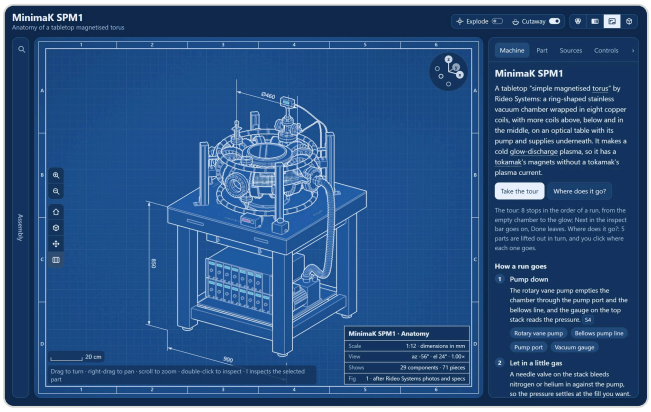
Colour

Solid shaded parts in their own colours with inked outlines, on a neutral stone ground. The selection is teal.



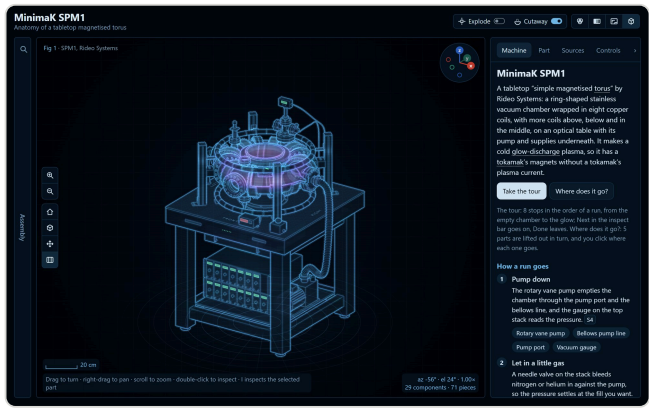
Greyscale

A white, CAD-style rendering with five flat shades and hard shadows. Only the plasma (pink-violet) and the selection (amber) are in colour.



Blueprint

White drafting lines on blue paper, set out as a drawing sheet: a frame with zones, centre lines, a grid, and a title block with the scale. Three dimensions (850, 900, Ø460 mm) can be dragged further off or along; double-click one to put it back. The selection is a red pencil mark.



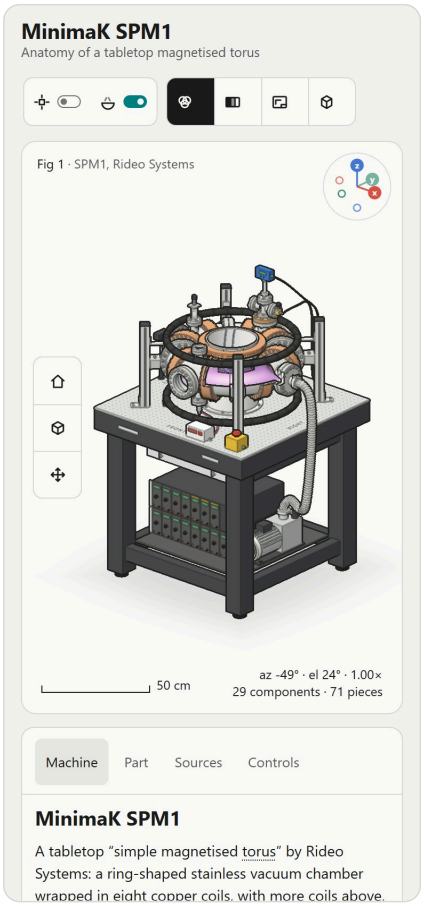
Hologram

Glowing ice blue on deep navy, so the inside of the machine shows through. The plasma glows violet and the selection orange. With no theme chosen, a dark system setting opens this one.

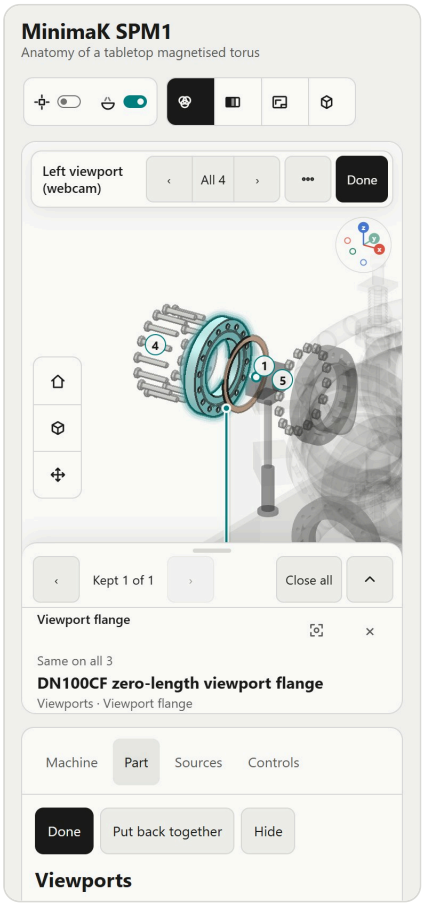
> **Zoomed out,** the lines inside each part fade and thin, as an illustrator draws a figure seen from further off; zoom in and every line comes back. A selected part always keeps all its lines.

11 Phones and tablets

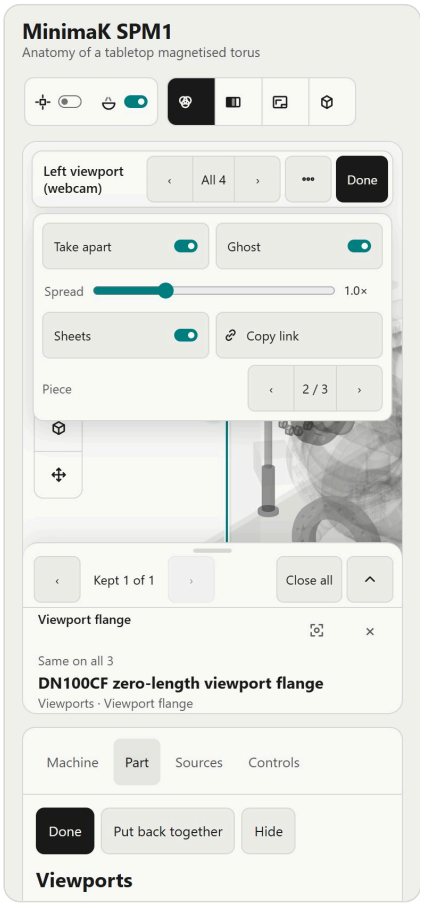
On a narrow screen the side panels stack under the model: scroll the page to read them. One finger turns the model, two fingers pan, and a pinch zooms.



The home view on a phone.



Inspecting: the bar is one row, and the sheets are a bottom sheet.



··· opens the rest of the inspect bar.

Inspecting on a phone

- **Tap** to select, **double-tap** to inspect.
- The inspect bar is one row: the part's name, one way to step, ··· and **Done**. ··· holds Take apart, Spread, Ghost, Sheets, Copy link and the pieces.
- The sheets are a **bottom sheet** that peeks under the part. Pull it up by its head (or tap the head) to read; push it down to peek again. Its arrows step through the kept sheets.

Hitting small parts

- A tap picks the smallest part within 24 px of your finger, so a tap on a flange beside a nut gets the nut.
- Inspecting, a tap **previews** a sub-part's sheet; **Keep** keeps it.
- **Loupe:** hold a finger still for half a second. A magnifier shows the view under it at 3×, with the name of what a tap there would pick. Slide to move it; lift to tap there.
- Every button is at least 44 px on a touch screen.

12 Links, settings and access

Share exactly what you see

The address in the browser follows what you are looking at: the part and piece, the kept sheets, the step, Show me, the view and the theme. Copy it, or press **Copy link** in the inspect bar, and anyone who opens it sees the same thing, even in a fresh browser. The browser's Back button returns to the part before.

`#part=gaskets&piece=right-back`	The right–back gasket, inspected
`&sheets=ofhc-copper-gasket`	…with its sheet kept
`&joint=1&step=2`	…with the joint opened at step 2
`#quiz=gauge,viewport,laser,needle,probe`	A quiz round of those five parts
`#theme=blueprint`	Opens in the Blueprint theme

A piece or sheet can be named by the start of its name, as `piece=right-back` above.

Settings

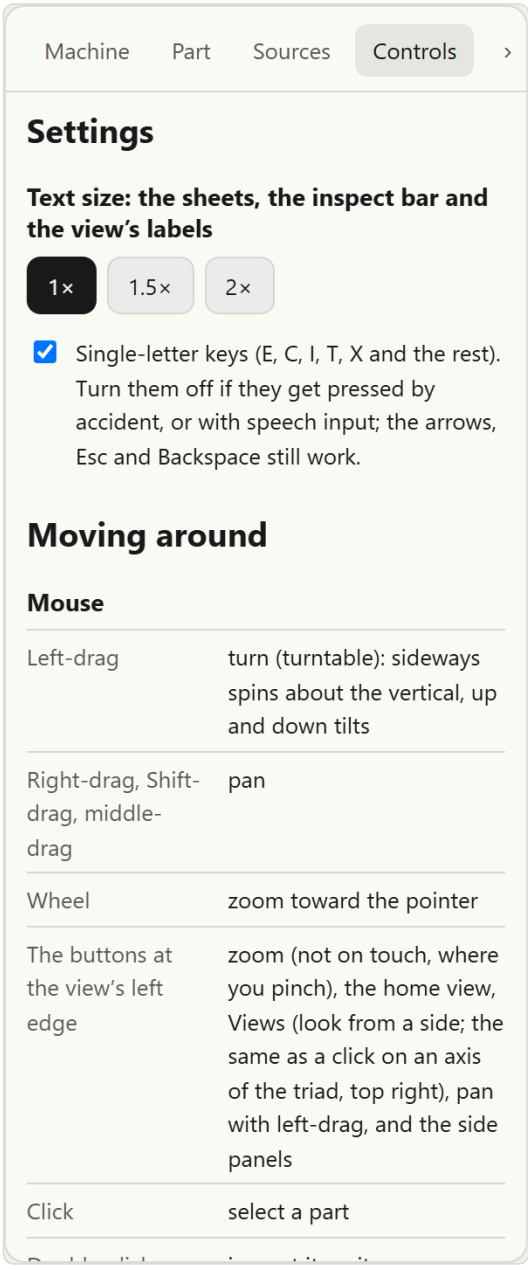
The **Controls** tab starts with two settings, which the page remembers:

- **Text size** 1×, 1.5× or 2× scales the sheets, the inspect bar, the view's labels and the tooltips, for a projector or a lecture hall.
- **Single-letter keys** can be turned off, for speech input or if keys get pressed by accident. The arrows, Esc and Backspace still work.

Below them, the Controls tab lists every mouse, touch and key binding.

Keyboard and screen readers

- The first Tab stop, **Skip to the assembly**, jumps to the list. In it, ↑ ↓ move, → ← open and close a group, Enter selects, Space hides or shows, and I inspects.
- The theme buttons are one Tab stop: ← → switch theme.
- A status line announces what changes, and the 3D view has a text description of what it shows and from which side.
- With reduced motion turned on in your system, glides become cuts and the animation stands still.



The Controls tab: the settings, then every binding.

13 Keys and gestures

Click the model first so it has the keys. With single-letter keys turned off, only the arrows, Esc and Backspace work.

The view

← → ↑ ↓	Turn
Shift + arrows	Pan
+ −	Zoom
0	Home view (inspecting, the part)
A	Fit everything shown
1–4	Three-quarter, front, right, above
O / P	Left-drag turns / pans
F	Fold or unfold the side panels

The machine

/	Find a part
E	Explode
[ ]	Less or more spread
C	Cutaway
H	Hide the selected part
I	Inspect the selected part

Mouse

Drag	Turn
Right-drag	Pan (also Shift-drag, middle-drag)
Wheel	Zoom toward the pointer
Click	Select; inspecting, keep a sheet
Double-click	Inspect; inspecting, Show me
Rest on a sub-part	Preview its sheet
Double-click space	Home view

Inspecting

T	Take apart
J	Open or close the joint
, .	Previous or next piece
G	Ghost on or off
S	Sheets on or off
Z	Show me
L	Floating sheets back into the column
Backspace	Back to the part you came from
Esc	One step back

Touch

One finger	Turn
Two fingers	Pan; pinch to zoom
Tap	Select; inspecting, preview a sheet
Double-tap	Inspect
Hold still	Loupe at 3×; lift to tap there

In the assembly list

↑ ↓	Move between rows
→ ←	Open or close a group
Enter	Select the part
Space	Hide or show it